

Muncie City Council Meeting December 2nd 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lkEuTnQEObY
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Muncie Common Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: December 2, 2024

Body: Muncie Common Council

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer [00:03:54](#) called the regular meeting of the Muncie Common Council to order, instructing attendees to silence phones.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mason, Selvie, Macintosh, Green, Howell, Garrett, Gilliam, Basham, Dishman (Presiding Officer).
 - **Members Absent:** (None explicitly stated; roll call indicated all listed members were present).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - [00:04:14](#) Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance.
 - [00:04:52](#) Opening prayer / invocation.

- **00:05:49 Citizen Recognition:** District 1 Councilman Jeff Green presented the December 2024 Citizen of the Month award to Courtney, President of the Muncie Southside Neighborhood Association, recognizing her extensive volunteerism, community organizing, and youth advocacy.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **00:12:22** Approval of the prior month's meeting minutes.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by roll call vote.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

Appointments to Boards and Commissions

- **00:13:09 MITS Board Reappointment (Julia Mason):**
 - **Presenter/Sponsor:** Julia Mason presented her request for reappointment, highlighting recent board visibility, community events, and collaborative relationships with local schools and city administration.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Nominated and approved by roll call vote (Yes: Mason, Powell, Gilliam, Garrett, Basham, Macintosh, Mason, Green, Bond/Dishman). *(Note: Transcript names vary slightly in roll call listings).*
 - **00:15:38 EDIT Board Reappointment (Watasha Barnes-Griffin):**
 - **Presenter/Sponsor:** Watasha Barnes-Griffin (308 North Mangrove Lane) sought reappointment to the Muncie EDIT Building Corporation, emphasizing board oversight of bonds, community service, and diversity of thought and representation.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Nominated and approved by roll call vote.
 - **00:17:23 Approval of City Council Dates and Deadlines:**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
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Ordinances & Resolutions (Ordinances 33-24 through 42-24)

- **00:31:14 Ordinance 33-24:** An ordinance amending Ordinance 24-23 fixing maximum salaries for appointed officers, employees, deputies, and assistants for the year 2025.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** City administration explained that salary ordinances establish caps and will align with adopted budget cuts, though variables prevent 100% exact parity. Legal counsel noted structural cleanup items.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended per legal counsel recommendations and adopted as amended by roll call vote.
- **00:39:07 Ordinance 34-24:** An ordinance fixing salaries for all elected officials of the City of Muncie for the year 2025.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments made to reflect council-passed budget numbers for elected officials.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote.
- **00:40:25 Ordinance 35-24:** An ordinance fixing maximum salaries for members of the Muncie Police Department for the year 2025.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote.
- **00:41:08 Ordinance 36-24:** An ordinance fixing maximum salaries for members of the Muncie Fire Department for the year 2025.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote.
- **00:42:02 Ordinance 37-24:** An ordinance establishing Title 9, Chapters 40, 41, 42, and 43 of the Muncie Code of Ordinances entitled **Code of Ethics**.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive debate occurred regarding proposed amendments from legal counsel and state municipal association (AIM) feedback. Proposals to table the item to a committee failed. Legal counsel read non-substantive clarifying amendments into the record (including military/medical virtual attendance exceptions, term start dates, personnel file integration, and a March 1, 2025 enforcement timeline delay).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Michael Wilson (Former Personnel Director) **00:57:59** spoke in favor, emphasizing transparency and accountability.
 - Elizabeth Edel **00:59:48** questioned delays and changes made months after advisory committee work.
 - Jeff Robinson [01:1:20] supported the ordinance and urged against undue reliance on AIM guidance.
 - Chip Taylor (Ethics Advisory Committee Chair) **01:17:16** clarified that committee drafts welcomed revisions but cautioned against weakening political activity safeguards.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended with legal counsel recommendations and adopted as amended by roll call vote.
- **01:20:13 Ordinance 38-24:** An ordinance amending Chapter 77 (Parking Regulations) of the Muncie Code of Ordinances.
 - **Presenter/Sponsor:** Police Department representatives presented comprehensive updates to local parking, safety enforcement, and abandoned vehicle tagging procedures (72-hour notice protocol) designed to keep fine revenues local under home rule.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by voice vote.
- **01:28:50 Ordinance 39-24:** An ordinance repealing Chapter 55 of the Muncie City Ordinances entitled **Cable Television**.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Repeals obsolete cable commission and franchise provisions preempted by state law and inactive for over a decade.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by voice vote.
- **01:28:19 Ordinance 40-24:** An ordinance repealing Chapter 34, Section 8 of the Muncie City Ordinances entitled **Muncie Cable Television Commission**.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by voice vote.
- **01:28:56 Ordinance 41-24:** An ordinance amending Chapter 52 of the Muncie City Ordinances entitled **Waste and Litter Care of Premises**.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Repeals redundant sections covered by later-adopted ordinances.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by voice vote.
- **01:29:56 Ordinance 42-24:** An ordinance amending the Muncie comprehensive zoning ordinance from R-5 Residence Zone to BV Variety Business Zone for the 4,000 Block North Morrison Road.
 - **Presenter/Sponsor:** Kathy Van Ice (Ashton Land Surveyor) presented the zoning map amendment to expand commercial/variety business zoning northward from Bethel and Morrison Road.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced by voice vote.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General community concerns addressed near the meeting's conclusion) - **01:32:23 Julia Mason (Bridges Community Service Board of Directors):** Announced that the Bridges Community Service Board dissolved as of October 2024. Detail asset sales and fund disbursements: \$118,000+ distributed to Better Way, Muncie Mission, Nonprofit Network, and YWCA; \$115,000 given to Ivy Tech Community College Foundation to establish culinary student scholarships. - **01:35:05 Joseph Romero (Founder, Shepherd's Heart and Hands):** **01:35:08** Reported on a recent Christmas event serving over 300 unhoused individuals. Discussed ongoing challenges regarding homeless encampment relocations (e.g., 10-day notice deadlines at major camps), advocated for structured, city-sanctioned temporary camping/tiny home sites with supportive services, and offered to partner with local agencies. - **01:49:49 Watasha Barnes-Griffin (CEO, YWCA):** **01:49:49** Highlighted the weekly meetings of the Muncie homeless provider consortium (YWCA, A Better Way, Muncie Mission, Christian Ministries, township trustees, Open Door Health) coordinating winter warming stations, emergency shelter beds, and coordinated entry for Region 6. - **01:53:26 Janetta Presley (Former Director, Fiona's Place):** **01:53:26** Discussed potential reopening of Fiona's Place as a warming center, noted fire safety hazards at encampments near railway tracks/industrial areas, and raised concerns regarding housing options for individuals restricted from traditional missions. - **01:52:49 Michael Wilson:** **01:52:49** Brief closing remarks reiterating support for ethical governance and thanking council members.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Committee updates regarding ongoing labor negotiations with FOP, IAFF Local 1348, and AFSCME **00:18:11**, as well as a report from Redevelopment

Commission appointee Andrew Dale 00:20:22.

- **Adjournment:** 01:55:17 Motion to adjourn approved by voice vote.

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